

Behavioural Psychology

Enhancing Personal Effectiveness and Emotional Well-Being



Psychology



- ‘**Psyche**’ means ‘**soul**’
- ‘**Logos**’ means ‘**study**’
- Psychology broke away from philosophy and physiology and emerged as a separate discipline some 100 years ago. Since its emergence as a separate science it has undergone a series of changes in its research methodology and definition.
- Psychology is the **science of human and animal behavior**.

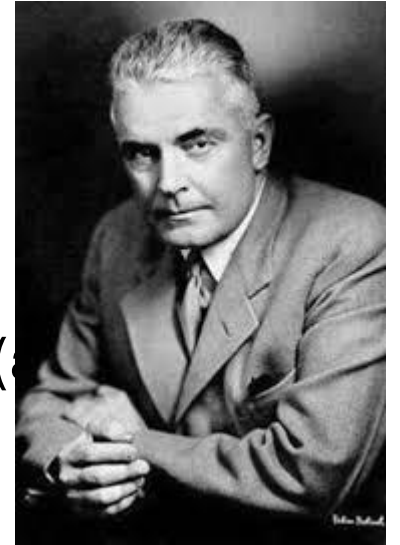
Scope of Psychology

- **Educational psychology** - Ways and methods of educating people.
- **Developmental psychology** – Physical, mental and social aspects of human development over the entire span of life.
- **Social psychology** - Study of how people's thoughts, feelings and actions are affected by others.
- **Clinical psychology** - Psychological disorders and their treatment.
- **Health psychology** - Preventive aspect of health than the curative aspect
- ☞ **Behavioral psychology** - Role of environment in developing behavior, ways of learning new knowledge and skills. Example: When introducing a new way of thinking in health- start from what community members already know and proceed from the known to the unknown.
 - It is about shaping human behavior using rewards. ▪ Toilet training in children
 - Dietary habit in the family ▪ Sanitation practices in the family

The origins of Behavioral Psychology

- Who founded behavioral psychology?

John B. Watson, American Psychologist in 1913 proposed that psychologists should focus on the **observable behavior of individuals**, rather than the invisible, inner workings of their minds (a theory that stemmed from Freud).



Later on, **B. F. Skinner**, American Psychologist theorized that **all of human behavior was shaped by our environment**, that we could be made to act in certain ways depending on the prior consequences of previous actions.

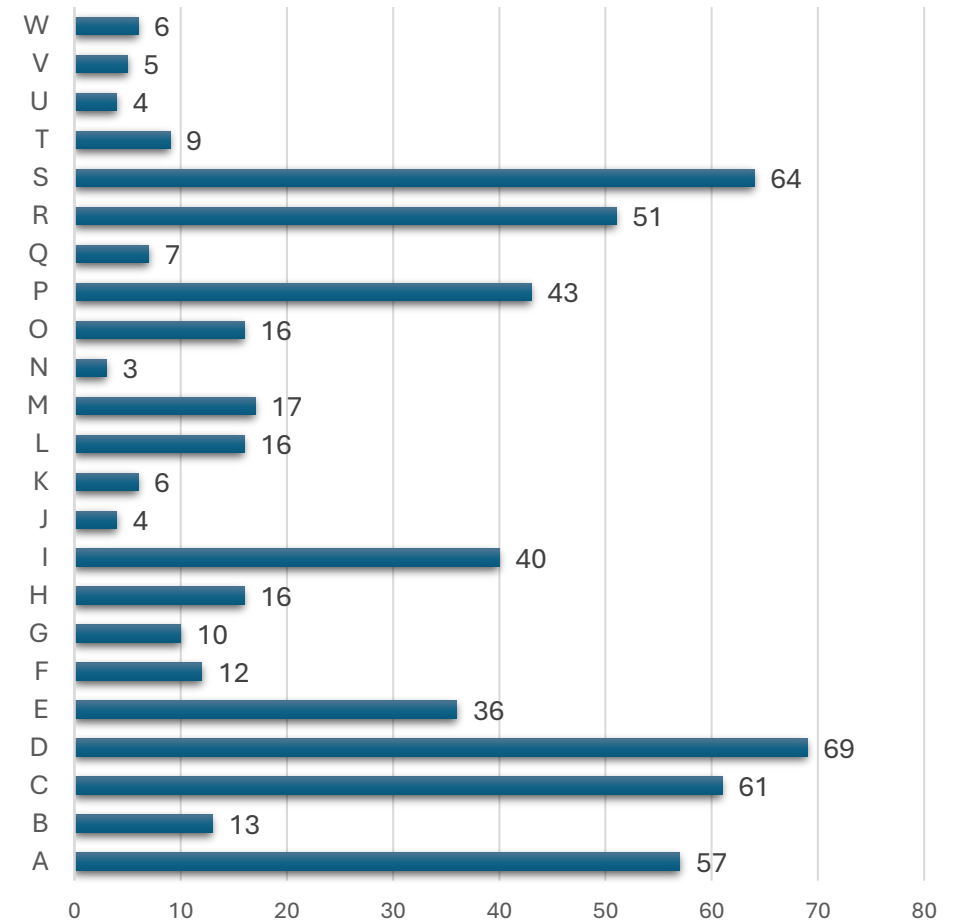
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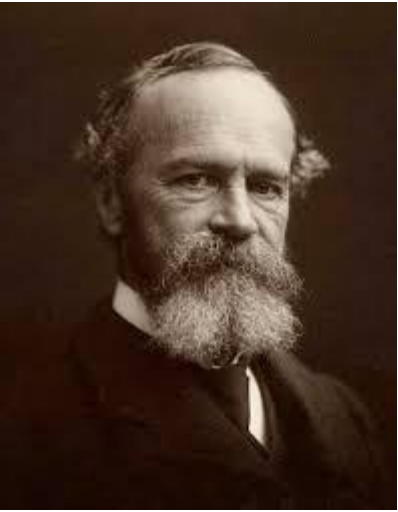
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**Number of words starting with Self-
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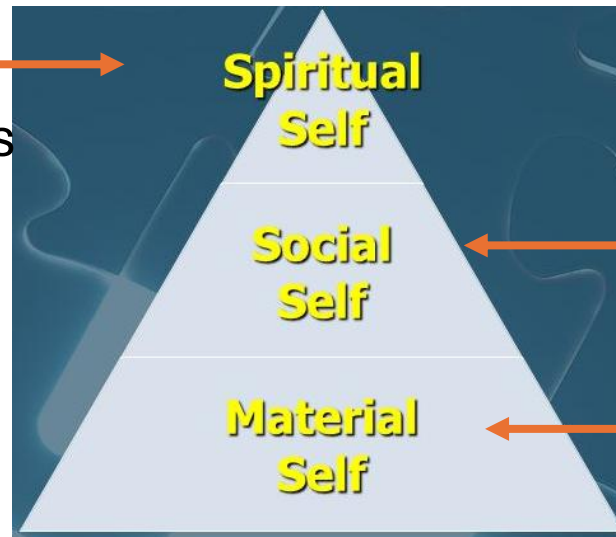
Components of Self



William James (1890), a famous psychologist, discussed the “**me**” which he called the “**empirical self**”

An individual’s **Me [empirical self]** is the **sum total** of **all that he CAN call his**, not only his body and his psychic powers, but his clothes, and his house, his wife and children, his ancestors and friends, his reputation and works, his properties, and bank account....etc

The **spiritual self** refers to the **psychological self** and comprises of our self perceived thoughts, beliefs, values, needs, motives, feelings, interests and traits.



The **social self** is the **self known by others**. Influences our self-image.

The **material self** refers to **all tangible objects, places and people** that are called as “mine₆” or “my”

Self-concept definition

Influential self-efficacy researcher **Roy Baumeister** (1999): “The individual’s belief about himself or herself, including the person’s attributes and who and what the self is.”

Rosenberg (1979): “...the totality of an individual’s thoughts and feelings having reference to himself as an object.”

Roger (1959) – Self-concept has 3 core aspects:

1. Self-Image – The view you have of yourself
2. Self-Worth – How much value you have in yourself
3. Ideal-Self – Who you really wish you were

Psychologist **Gordon Allport** (1955) refers to the self as **Proprium**. Proprium relates to personal states that are experienced as “**peculiarly mine**”. Most of our **behavior** are according to **our qualities** and **reflect who we are and who we want to be**. It indicates expressing our own **unique ‘self’**. This Allport calls as ‘**propriate functioning**’.



Seven aspects in the development of the proprium:

A sense of bodily self	1-3 yrs	Child begins to recognize that it is an object in a world of objects
Self identity	1-3 yrs	Language; Child’s name
Self esteem or pride	1-3 yrs	More explorative and likes to master and control one’s environment.
Self extension	3-6 yrs	Sense of self extends to include objects which are not a part of one’s bodily self. A sense of possessiveness
Self image	3-6 yrs	How a child views itself in the eyes of others.
Rational coping	6-12 yrs	Child develops the self awareness. Developing moral and cognitive abilities to find rational solutions to daily life dilemmas.
Propriate striving	6-12 yrs	Child enters adolescence, future becomes important. Intentional ₈ planning of one’s life goals.

Who are you? What makes ‘you’?

“I’m a

- The self has an “I” that thinks and “me” is the content of those thoughts.
- In psychology, this sense of self/the ‘me’/ the set of beliefs I hold about myself: **self-concept**.
- Refers to a person’s thoughts, feelings and experiences about the self. The idea about who you are, were and will become.
- This sense is developed early in life, but it goes through constant evaluation and
- Multidimensional: Physical, Psychological, Attitudinal



Key message for ‘**positive self concept**’

- The direction of the spiral can usually be changed by **looking at the positive things in our lives** and accentuating them while trying to **put the negative items in proper perspective; deal with them one at a time**. Some negatives simply cannot be changed and must be dealt with in other ways.
- By making the choice to be pleasant, happy, and content, a mother or father can greatly affect the attitude of a spouse and children. The attitude of the teenagers can greatly affect the way others treat them as well.
- It is usually well worth our time to stop for a moment and see if the negative ways others are treating us could have anything to do with how we present and treat ourselves.
- **Who is ultimately responsible for the way we act?**

Each person is responsible for the way he/she acts.



Self-concepts are rarely all positive or all negative; someone may have both positive and some negative self-concepts in different domains

Example:

A husband who thinks of himself as a good father but sees his physical self as out-of-shape and unhealthy.

A student who think of themselves as a great athlete who struggles academically.

Positive Self-Concept

I can do anything I really want to do.

I have definite strengths and abilities.

I am an okay person

I see myself as being as good as my friends.

There are many ways to solve a problem.

Negative Self-Concept

Why try? I could never do it anyway.

I am not nearly as good as my friends.

I am a boring person.

I knew my plans would not work.

I cannot do anything right.



Some examples of positive self-concepts

- A person sees herself as an intelligent person
- A man perceives himself as an important member of his community
- A woman sees herself as an excellent spouse and friend
- A person thinks of himself as a nurturing and caring person
- A person views herself as a hard-working and competent employee

Some examples of negative self-concepts

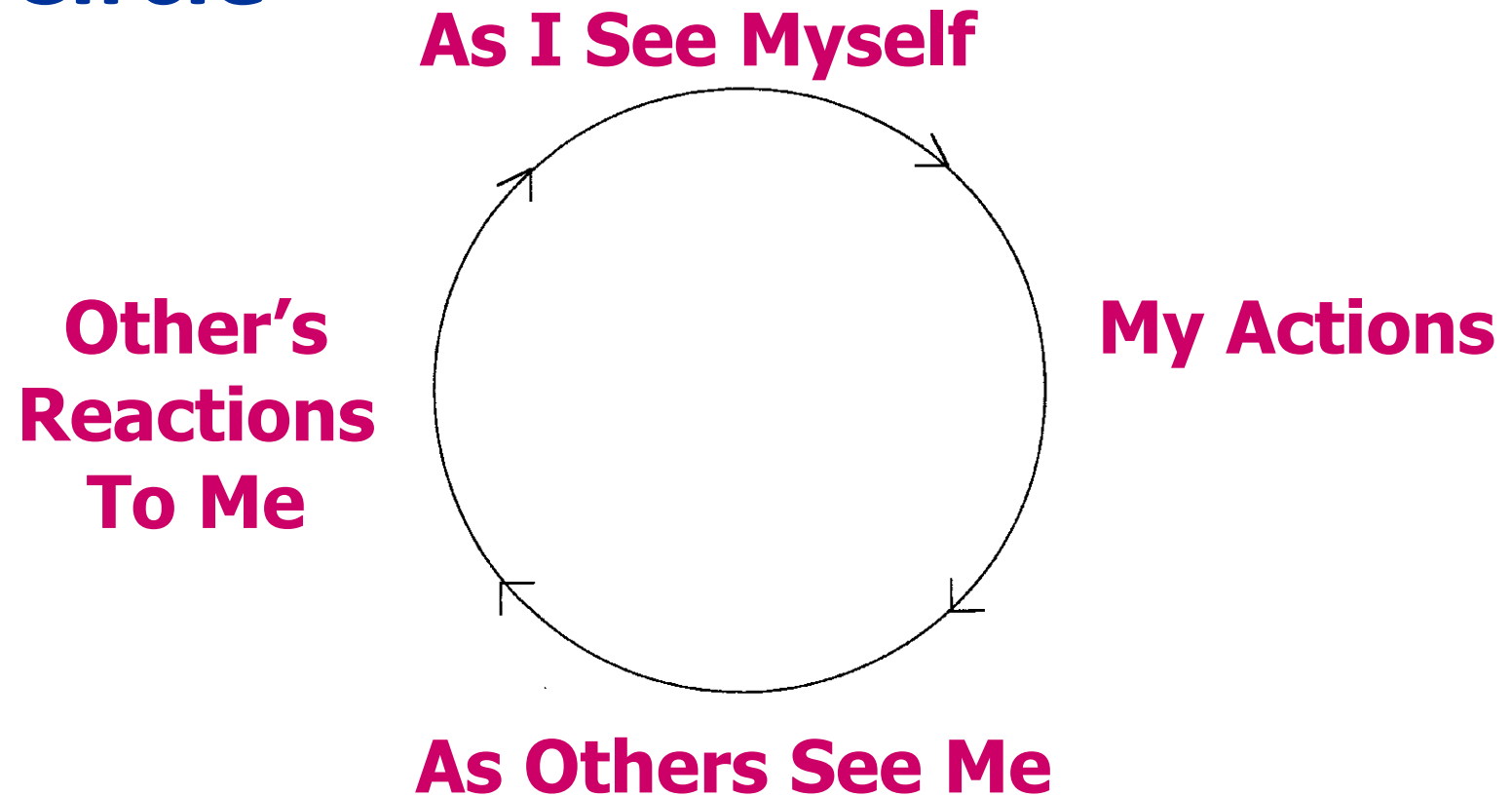
- A person sees herself as stupid and slow
- A man perceives himself as a burden on his community
- A woman sees herself as a terrible spouse and friend
- A person thinks of himself as an unapproachable person
- A person views herself as a lazy and incompetent employee

The person I think I am (your self-perception)

The person others think I am (how others perceive you)

The person others think I think I am (how you believe others see you)

Self-Concept Circle



CASE STUDY

DESCRIPTION OF A MOTHER

One morning a young mother got up and looked in the mirror. She began concentrating on everything that was wrong in her life. As she stared into the mirror, this is what she concentrated upon:

- * She was 35 years old and had just found her first wrinkle.
- * She had already plucked three gray hairs that morning.
- * She had gained 13 kgs after having four children and had not been able to lose any of the weight.
- * She wanted to be a stay-home mom, but had to work to pay the bills.
- * She was once a tidy housekeeper until the four children, ages three months to six years, came along; but now her house looked like disaster.
- * She was frustrated by the commitment she had made to a do a service project which she does not have time to fulfill.



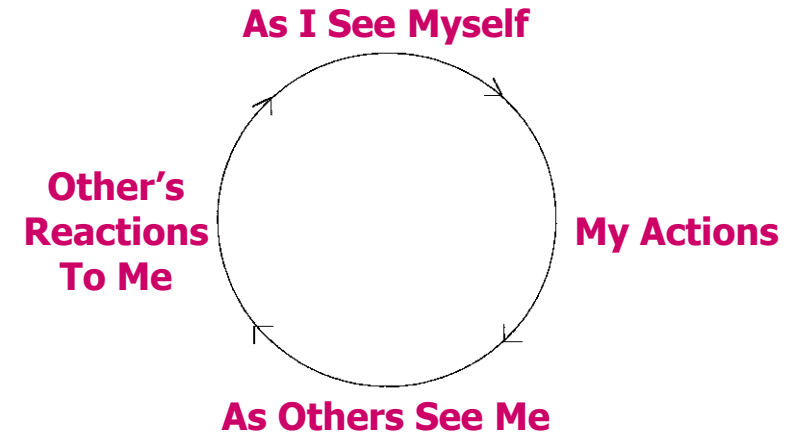


CASE STUDY

DESCRIPTION OF A TEENAGE GIRL

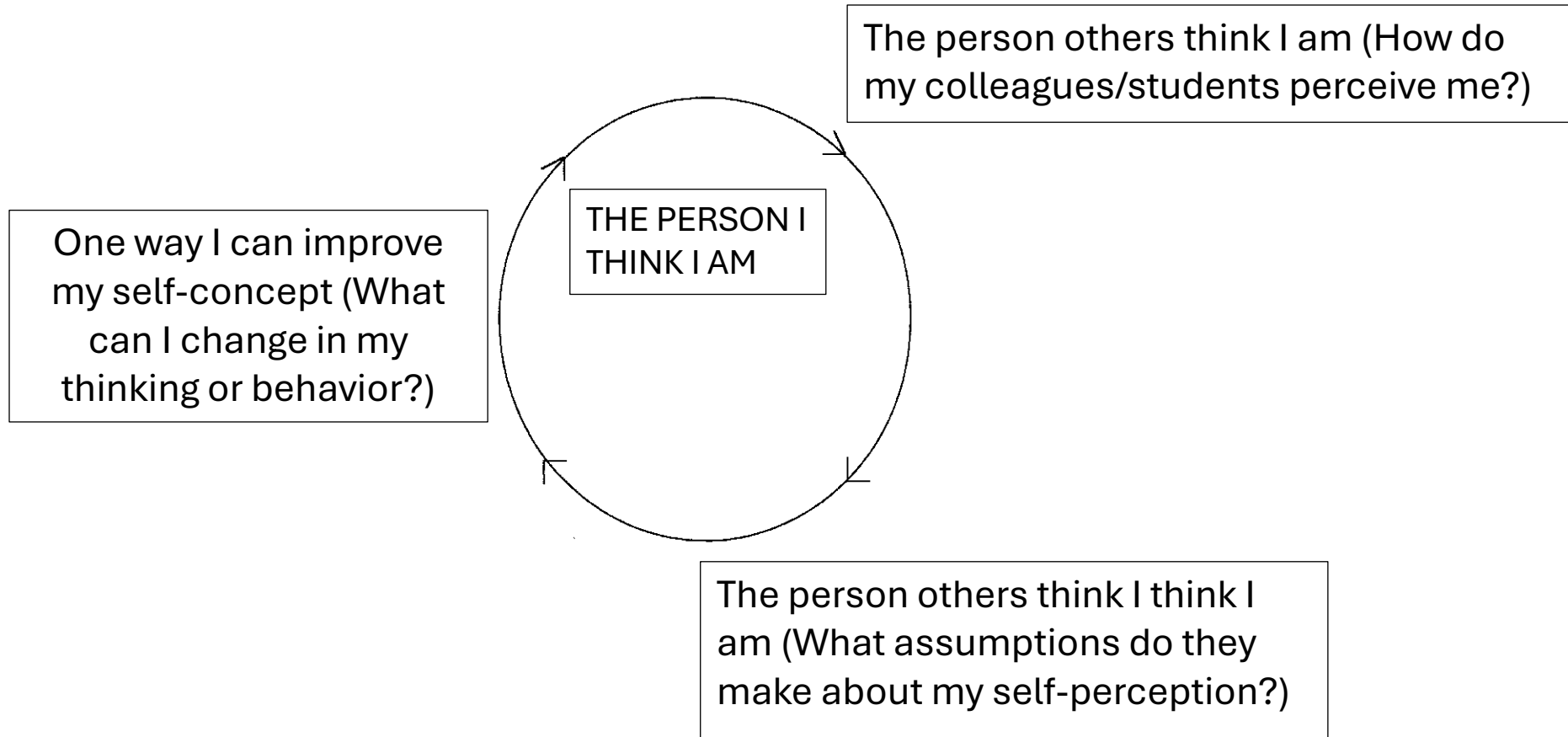
A teenage girl got up and looked in the mirror one morning. As she stood there, she began pointing out all of her flaws:

- * Her hair looked awful again. Why didn't her haircut look like friend Jenny's? Jenny's was so cute.
- * She had three new pimples. The cover-up she put on them only made them more noticeable.
- * Her friends did not care about her. They had not even asked her to go with them last weekend for movie. Why should they care about her? Her clothes were so ugly they probably did not want to be seen with her.
- * She had a test in Chemistry that day and she had not even studied for it.



- How will the teen see herself?
- How will the teen act toward others?
- How will the teen think others see her?
- How will others act toward the teen?
- What effect does this have on how she sees herself?
- Where is the spiral headed and how can its motion be reversed?

Self-Concept Reflection Map





The Twenty Statements Test by Kuhn (1960)

This exercise asks you to look at how social affiliations help to shape our self-concept.

- Write down twenty different responses to the question “Who am I?”
- Don’t worry about evaluating the logic or importance of your responses—just write the they occur to you.
- Give yourself five minutes to complete this task.

1. I am	
2. I am	
3. I am	
4. I am	
5. I am	
6. I am	
7. I am	
8. I am	
9. I am	
10. I am	
11. I am	
12. I am	
13. I am	
14. I am	
15. I am	
16. I am	
17. I am	
18. I am	
19. I am	
20. I am	

Now it's time to score your responses according to the following four categories:

USE YOUR BEST JUDGEMENT

A-mode responses	Physical characteristics or attributes	I am tall, I am tired, I am a Chennai resident
B-mode responses	Socially defined relationships, roles and statuses usually associated with group membership	I am a college student, I am a gamer, I am a son, I am an Indian
C-mode responses	Personal traits, styles of behaviour, emotional states	I am a happy person, I am talented, I am a fashionable dresser
D-mode responses	More general than specific; May express an abstract or existential quality	I am alive, I am part of the universe, I am a human being

Now count the number of each type of response and provide the totals for each mode

A-mode responses	“skin-deep” self	Based more on their appearance to others than on their internal qualities
B-mode responses	“institutional” self	Willingness to adhere to group standards and accept group obligations as well as an orientation toward the future and a sense that the individual is linked to others
C-mode responses	“impulsive” self	Pursuit of individual satisfaction, an orientation toward the present, and a sense that the individual should not be linked to other and that group obligations inhibit individual expression
D-mode responses	***	Harder to categorize and may feel uncertain about the source of their sense of self

Introduction to Values, Attitude and Behaviour

Introduction to Values

- Values are the guiding principles that shape our behavior, decisions, and interactions.
- They influence our perception of right and wrong.
- Derived from culture, upbringing, and experiences.
- Help create a meaningful and purpose-driven life.



Organizational Values

- Just as individuals have values, Organizations and institutions do have values.
- In fact, if we were to examine any company, we would discover that one or more business values was the key to their success.

Tata Group

-  **Core Values:** Integrity, Excellence, Responsibility, Unity, Innovation
 - ◆ **Example:** Tata has a reputation for **ethical leadership** and **corporate social responsibility** (e.g., Tata Trusts donates a large portion of its profits to social causes).
- **Infosys**
-  **Core Values:** Client Value, Leadership by Example, Integrity, Fairness, Excellence
 - ◆ **Example:** Infosys maintains **high integrity.



Organisation Values

Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bangalore

📌 **Core Values:** Excellence, Integrity, Innovation, Research-driven Growth, Sustainability

- ♦ **Example:** IISc is known for **academic excellence** and **cutting-edge research** in science and engineering. The university emphasizes **integrity** in research, **collaboration**, and a strong commitment to **solving real-world problems**.

Harvard University (USA)

📌 **Core Values:** Excellence, Leadership, Integrity, Diversity, Innovation, Impact

- ♦ **Example:** Harvard fosters a culture of **academic excellence and ethical leadership**. It promotes **diversity and inclusion**, ensuring that students from all backgrounds have access to quality education.

Values – The key issues

- The key point to keep in mind about values is that implementing them *energizes* everything concerned with it.
- For an individual, committing to and **applying values releases fresh energies**, which always attract success, achievement, and well-being.
- Likewise, we adopt values, individuals working at the organization become energized, as do its customers, its products and services, and everyone and everything else associated with that organization.

Why Values are Important

- Define personal identity and integrity.
- Drive motivation and goal-setting.
- Strengthen relationships and social harmony.
- Guide ethical decision-making. [Ethics deals with **moral principles, values, and judgments** that guide human behaviour and actions in order to achieve a **good and fulfilling life**.]



Categories of Values

- **Personal Values** – Honesty, self-respect, resilience.
- **Cultural Values** – Traditions, customs, and heritage.
- **Social Values** – Equality, justice, cooperation.
- **Moral Values** – Integrity, responsibility, kindness.
- **Spiritual Values** – Faith, compassion, gratitude.



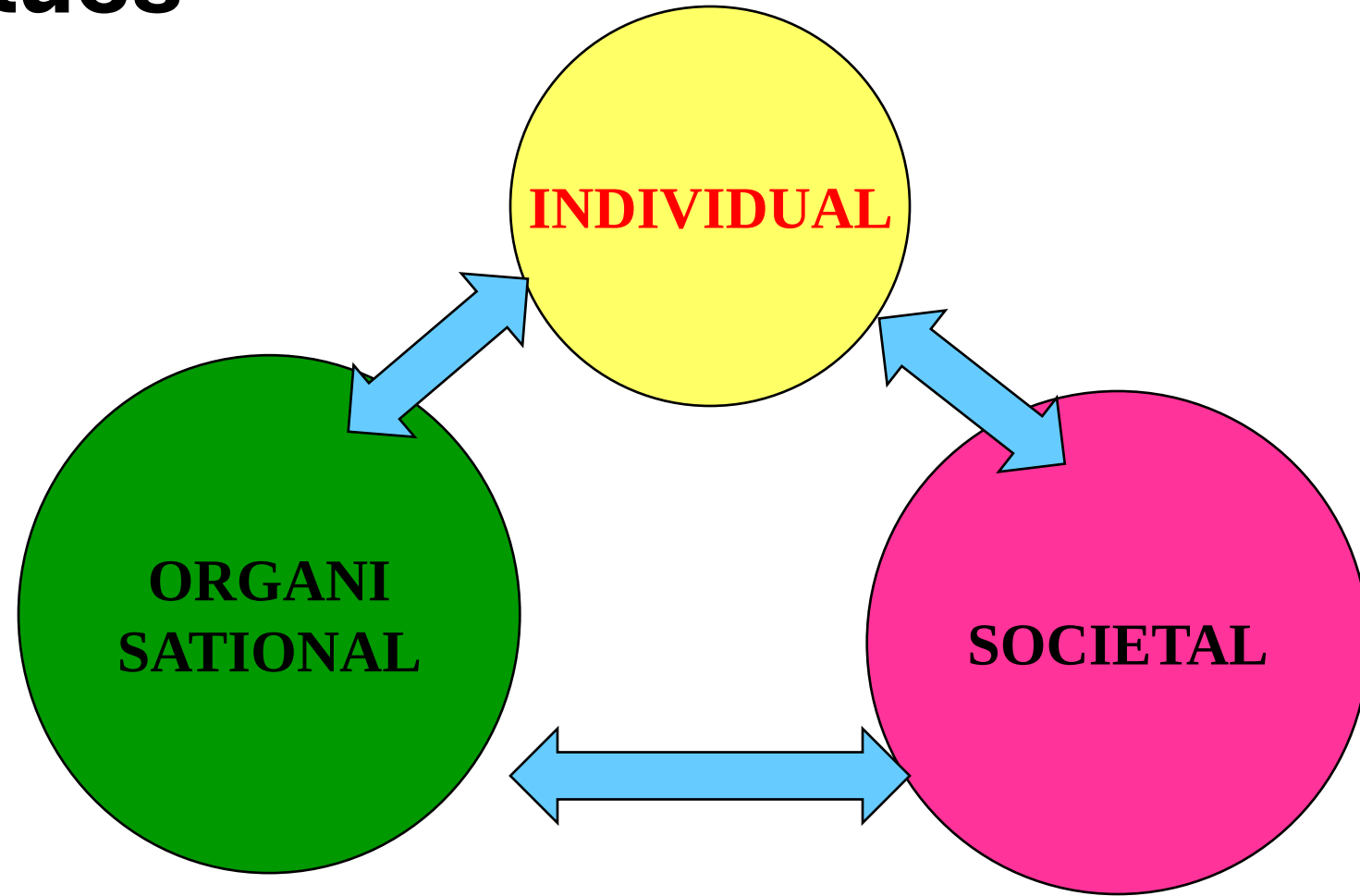
What are CORE values?

They are those **VALUES** which do not change with:

- Time
- Gender
- Nationality
- Geographical location
- Educational level
- Economic status



Integration of Values



Activity

Fix a chart or Pick a Board:

Volunteer 3 Students to come with their pens

- First - Place your initials at a comfortable height on the chart.
- Second - Again, place your initials higher than the earlier attempt.
- Third - Again place your initials higher than the earlier attempt.
- Audience, Can you find out who is the winner out of the three.
- Learning: Always Aim higher in life, push yourself. Do better

Attitude

- **Attitude is a personality trait you continue to develop throughout your life.**
- **Your attitude pervades your action and is evident in every detail of your life and how you relate to others**
- **Attitude varies from person to person, situation to situation**
- **However over a period of time, and based on own experiences, people tend to develop “types” of attitude**
- **Attitude begins in the inside and shows on the outside.**

Attitude (contd)

Your attitude is evident in your

- Speech
- Body language
- Task completion
- Attention to detail
- Consideration for others
- Approach to yourself
- General approach to life

Attitudes

Attitudes are the reflections of our mind on our actions and behaviours

They are determined by our:

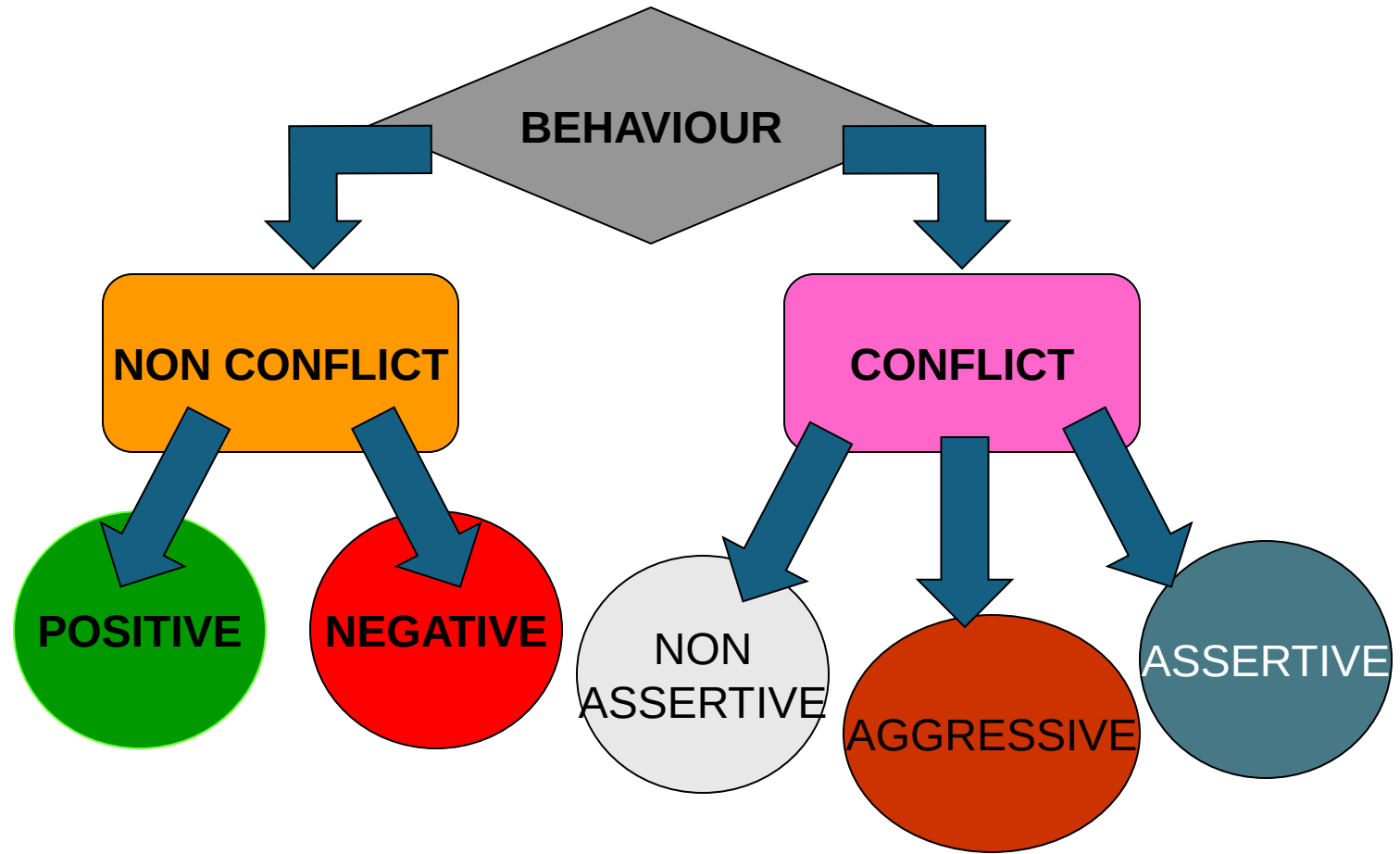
- ⊕ Emotions
- ⊕ Experiences
- ⊕ Expectations

Positive or **Negative** – the choice is yours!

9 Attitudes of highly productive people

1. **Curiosity**
2. **Accepting that problems will exist**
3. **Meeting Challenges**
4. **Constructive criticism**
5. **Considered judgment**
6. **Optimism**
7. **Perseverance**
8. **Learning from failure**
9. **Flexibility in approach**

Behaviour



To summarise.....

- **Thinking** is the basis of value
- **Value** leads to expectations
- **Expectations** determine attitude
- **Attitude** directs behaviour
- **Behaviour** effects performance
- **Performance** leads to results

Behavioural Psychology



Building up self-concept

- Building up self concept is primary factor of **effective personality behaviour**.
- What self-aspects are required to build self-concept?
 - Self recognition
 - Self-concept clarity
 - Self-concept differentiation
 - Self monitoring
 - Self advocacy
 - Self awareness
 - Self acceptance
 - Self realization
 - Self disclosure

Self awareness

Our attention is sometimes directed outward towards the environment, and sometimes focused inward on ourselves.



How to be self-aware?



A person must be able to recognize and label their own feelings, thoughts, and behaviors. If a person is self-aware, they can assess their own physical, mental, and emotional states and understand there are various aspects of their internal personality that allow them to interact with the external world.

Types of self-awareness

Private self-awareness is a form of awareness that happens in a moment of realization that doesn't involve an outside influence or event. It is **internal**. How clearly we see our own values, passions, aspirations, fit with our environment, reactions (including thoughts, feelings, behaviors, strengths, and weaknesses), and impact on others.

Public self-awareness focuses on a person's ability to understand how others perceive them. They are more likely to conform to social norms and to behaviors that don't draw negative attention. It is **external**. How other people view us.



Why is it **important** to have self awareness?



People with strong self-awareness skills. **What can they do and achieve?**

Why is it important to have self awareness?

- A better understanding of what you need
- Better decision making
- Decreased reactivity to situations and people
- Increased self-esteem
- Recognizing what you do well and what you struggle with
- Aligning with your values and living a more congruent life
- Being better in relationships as you learn how others perceive you
- Being able to better manage emotions
- Reduces stress as you know how to decrease anxiety for yourself
- Boost communication skills and enhance self-confidence
- Encourage positive self-development

People with strong self-awareness skills can?

- Recognize their strengths and challenges
- Understand and talk about their needs and feelings
- Recognize other people's needs and feelings
- See how their behavior affects others
- Develop a growth mindset and learn from their mistakes
- When people understand themselves better, it's easier for them to build positive self-esteem.
- Important for self-monitoring and self-advocacy

The Four Self-Awareness Archetypes

This 2x2 maps internal self-awareness (how well you know yourself) against external self-awareness (how well you understand how others see you).



Self recognition

- Acknowledgement that ‘**Yes, I am an individual and I am different from others**’
- Once a person has this distinction, they also have the ability to become **self-aware**.
- Self awareness will come from **self-recognition**. Till you do not recognize your true identity you cannot explore yourself or rather get into self awareness.



Self-monitoring



- Why do some people have trouble figuring out what needs to be done to complete a task?
- Why some people struggle noticing mistakes in work they've done and correcting them?

Self-monitoring is a skill we use all the time to **keep track of what we're doing.**

It's a **series of assessments** we make along the way: How is the activity going? What's working and what's not? Should I make adjustments?



- Self-advocacy is the **ability to communicate what your needs are**.
- People who know how to self-advocate are **more likely to do well** in school, work, and life. They often **feel confident** in what they're learning and doing.
- Self-advocacy also **creates independence**. And it **empowers people to find solutions to problems**.



Self acceptance

- Individual's **satisfaction or happiness** with oneself
- Necessary for **good mental health**
- Self acceptance involves **self-understanding**, a realistic awareness of one's strengths and weaknesses.
- It results in an individual's feeling that they are of "**unique worth**"

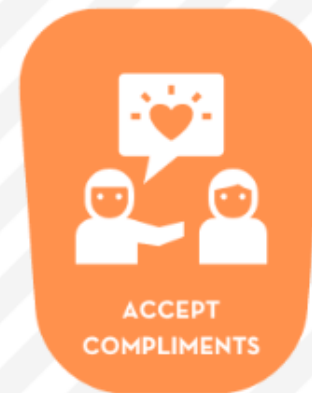
9 TIPS FOR SELF-ACCEPTANCE



OWN YOUR
WEIRD



FORGIVE YOURSELF
& OTHERS



ACCEPT
COMPLIMENTS



CHOOSE KIND
FRIENDS



INCREASE POSITIVE
SELF-TALK



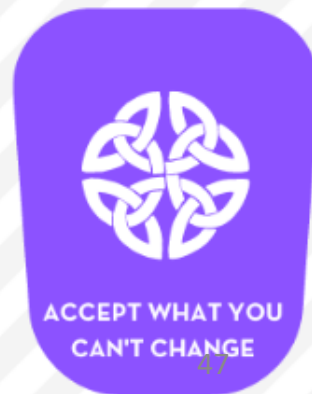
DECREASE NEGATIVE
SELF-TALK



GET REAL WITH
COMPARISONS



MAKE & KEEP
COMMITMENTS
TO SELF



ACCEPT WHAT YOU
CAN'T CHANGE

Self realization

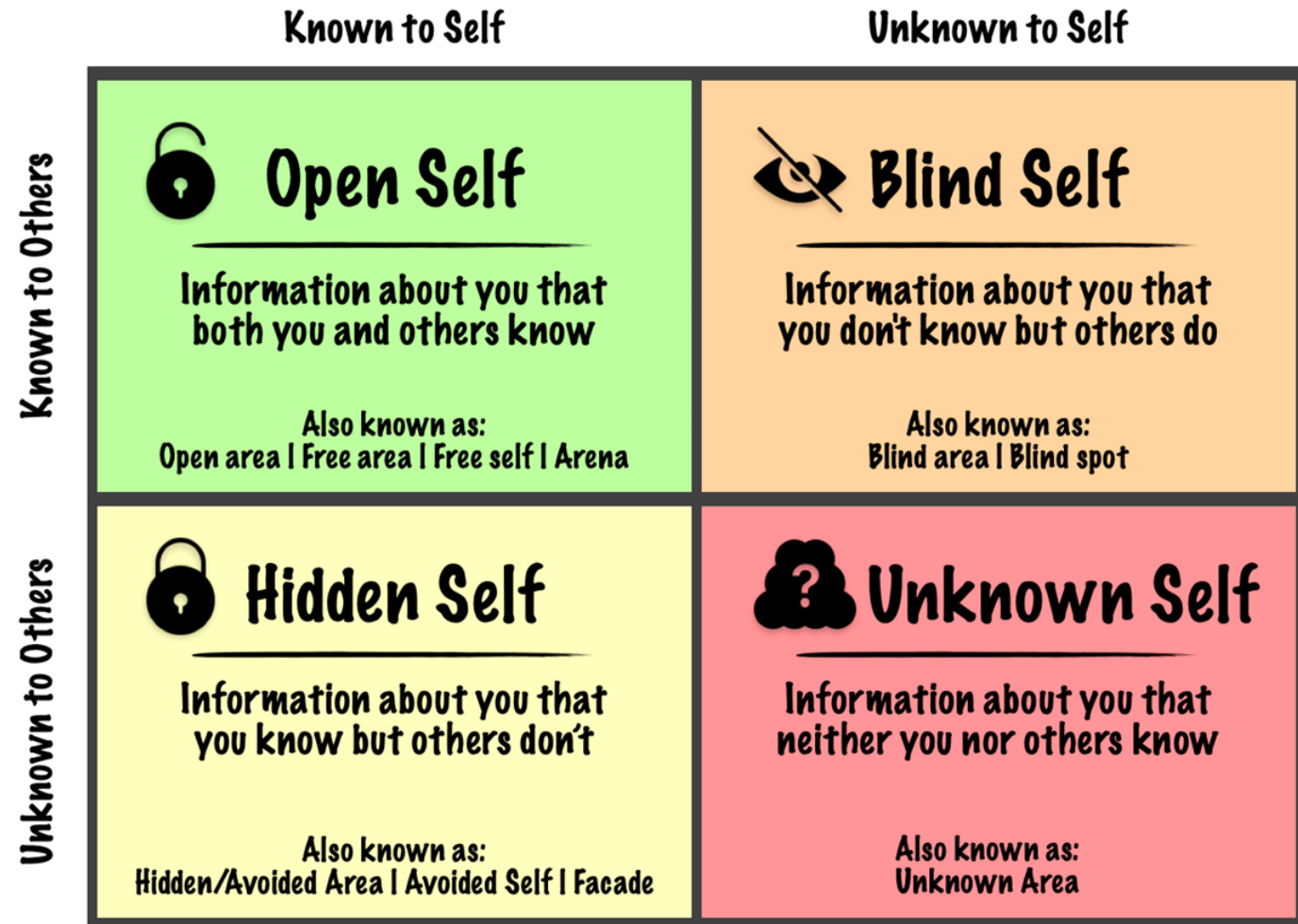
- **Fulfilment of one's own potential.**
- It is realizing our inner potentialities
- Involves growth and development motivated from within.
- It is a willingness to pursue our ideal-self on our own, to grow and to change because we think it is important.



Self disclosure

- Disclosing our **innermost thoughts and feelings**.
- Towards a **mature self concept** – how we are going to reveal our ‘self’, and this is where self-awareness plays an important role.
- We need to **know ourselves well before** we can disclose or reveal anything to others about our ‘real self’.
- Research indicates that self-disclosure leads **to self-contentment**, helps a person to be more perceptive, adaptive, competent, trusting and positive towards others.

Johari Window Model



Scenarios

Academic Stress - A bright final-year engineering student, openly shares with friends and faculty that he's under pressure due to upcoming campus placements. He jokes about stress but avoids showing how anxious and overwhelmed he truly feels inside.

Increased Screen Time - Spends excessive time on social media and gaming, even during lectures. While she believes it's harmless and manageable, her grades are dropping, and peers feel disconnected from her.

Communication Skills - Considers himself friendly and sociable, actively participating in class discussions and group projects. Unknowingly, he tends to dominate conversations and unintentionally cuts others off.

Self-Esteem and Fear of Judgment - Consistently scores well but never volunteers for presentations or leadership roles. She appears calm and confident but secretly fears being judged or making mistakes in front of others.

Self confidence

- **Believing yourself to be capable** – to specific tasks or attitude you hold about your abilities in life.
- A feeling of trust in one's abilities, qualities, and judgement.
- $\uparrow$ self confidence = $\uparrow$ self esteem



Self-Concept Clarity

- Self-Concept Clarity is different from self-concept.
- Self-Concept Clarity (SCC) refers to **how clear, confident, and consistent an individual's definitions of themselves are.**
- **Higher SCC** indicates a **firmer and more stable self-concept**, while **low SCC** indicates that an individual is **unclear or vague about who they really are.**
- Those with **low SCC** may struggle with **low self-esteem, self-consciousness, and neuroticism.**

Self-Concept Differentiation

- Self-Concept Differentiation (SCD) refers to **how an individual's self-representation may vary across contexts or social roles** (e.g., self as a spouse, self as a parent, self as a student).
- Having a high SCD may be viewed as a bad thing, but it can also be an effective coping mechanism for succeeding in the modern world where individuals have many different roles. If **SCD is very high**, it might mean that the **individual does not have a stable self-concept** and “wears a different mask” for each of their roles.
- A **very low level of SCD** may indicate that the individual is authentically “them” across all of their roles—although it may also indicate that he **cannot effectively switch from one role to another**.

Techniques of self awareness



What is self-awareness? Elaborate on the various techniques of self-awareness. What self-awareness techniques do you practice? Or provide reasons if you do not practise any.

Techniques of self awareness

WRITTEN EXERCISES

1. Write morning pages
2. Keep a journal
3. Use feedback analysis
4. Create a life vision-mission
5. Write a personal manifesto
6. Record your personal narrative
7. Write down your most important tasks regularly
8. Create a bucket list

TEST YOU CAN TAKE BY YOURSELF

1. Know and understand your personality type
2. Discover your Eulerian Destiny
3. Utilize The Freedom Diagram

WITH HELP FROM OTHERS

1. Ask for constructive feedback at work/study
2. Ask trusted friends or family for feedback
3. Apologize

Techniques of self awareness

PHYSICAL EXERCISES

1. Be aware of your body language
2. Practice grounding techniques
3. Observe other people
4. Take a morning walk
5. Read more books
6. Engage in solo exercise and individual sports
7. Practice conscious breathing
8. Meditate

THOUGHT PROCESS EXERCISES

1. Ask the “Three Whys”
2. Put a name to your feelings and emotions
3. Pay emotion to your self-talk
4. Question your assumptions
5. Ask questions about yourself
6. Observe your stream of consciousness
7. Build the Pause-and-Plan Response habit

<https://positivepsychology.com/building-self-awareness-activities/>

WRITTEN EXERCISES

- **Write morning pages:** Write 3 pages every morning as soon as you wake up – no shorthand writing. It helps you clear confusion and recognize important tasks that you need to take care off.
- **Keep a journal:** It helps your track your feelings, thoughts and life events. You can always ponder back into your past and learn from them. Reading your past journals helps you grow and get matured in life.
- **Use feedback analysis:** When you are making an important decision, write down how and why you doing so. After a few month (set the time) review it and analyze your decision – if you have done it right.
- **Create a life vision-mission:** Life an organization has its own mission and vision statements, you need to create your vision-mission statement. It should define your priorities. It will help set considerable and practically achievable goals and provide a strategic way to gauge your success.

WRITTEN EXERCISES

- **Write a personal proposal:** Write how you want to live your life. What your core values, beliefs, ideas and priorities are? What are your strengths? How will you define yourself? It will set you in the right direction to help achieve your goals. Consult this personal proposal as often as possible.
- **Record your ABCs:** Timing: When you experience an adverse effect.

This is a good activity to do after you experience an adverse event. It is a helpful way to debrief yourself and get a chance to reflect and discover your beliefs after a big, negative incident occurs in your life.

After every big negative life event, take time to reflect on the ABCs.

A - Activating event that triggers your inner dialogue

B - Belief you formed after the event

C - Consequences or how your new belief makes you feel

Write them down – it will help you move forward in your life. You will be able to look at things more positively and solve problems and stay calm.

WRITTEN EXERCISES

- **Write a regret letter:** Write a letter to your younger self telling all you regret for. Apologize for your mistakes that you have made or for losing good opportunities.
- **Do the funeral test:** Timing: Once. Here, in this test write about how you want people to speak about you at your funeral. Ask what they should remember about you and how you want people perceive you as a person. It will add more purpose to your daily routine and overall life.
- **Record your personal narrative:** If you have to narrate your life to someone – how would it be. So map out what you think brought a positive change in your life.
- **Write down your most important tasks regularly:** Timing: 1 times per Day. Writing three most important tasks (of the next day) every night will help you achieve more every day. You would start your day being aware of your purpose for the day.

WRITTEN EXERCISES

- **Create a bucket list:** Prepare a bucket list with all your personal and professional goals. It helps your focus and even motivates you to accomplish something that will end up crossing stuff off the list.

TEST YOU CAN TAKE BY YOURSELF

- **Analyze your personality:** Knowing yourself helps you understand why you're different or similar to others. Doing so will help you recognize your feelings and manage your time and energy better, and help you recognize your emotions. If required take some free online psychometric tests.

TEST YOU CAN TAKE BY YOURSELF

- **Discover your Eulerian Destiny:**

Timing: When you need to define your purposes in life.

Identifying your Eulerian Destiny awakens decisive thinking and self-reflection. Ask yourself the following questions:

- What did you grow up around?
- What do strangers say about you?
- What have you done for the past 5 to 10 years?
- What can you talk about continually for hours?

Write these down in four overlapping circles and see where they all meet. It may be time-consuming but the result will define and refine your purposes in life.

TEST YOU CAN TAKE BY YOURSELF

- **Utilize the Freedom Diagram:**

The three components of The Freedom Diagram are talent, fun, and demand. Talent is what you are pretty good at. The fun is what you wish you could do all the time, even if you are not paid for it. Demand is what people need or want you to do, and will pay for.

Creating this guide for you will help you decide what skill you should focus on learning so you can succeed in life.

THOUGHT PROCESS EXERCISES

- **Be aware of your body language:** Sometimes self-awareness activities are not about what you do or say but how you go about doing it. Body language is an example of this. Evaluate your own body language by studying a video of yourself so you can find ways to improve.
- **Practice grounding techniques:** Grounding techniques can be used to help keep you in the present. These techniques keep you grounded and help relieve anxiety and make future tasks seem easier to do
- **Observe other people:** Observing other people can be a fun and potentially worthwhile hobby. It helps you learn about how similar or different you are from them. Knowing that other people are observing you as well will certainly help you be more self-aware.
- **Take a morning walk:** Taking a walk first thing in the morning can help you meditate about what is going on in your life, and your goals for the day. Sort your feelings and make a productive action plan.

PHYSICAL EXERCISES

- **Practice Zhan Zhuang:** Timing: 1 times per day. Zhan Zhuang is a simple yet effective tai chi standing practice that helps you gain mental clarity and energy.
- **Read more books:** Timing: 1 times per day. Reading a variety of materials on a regular basis improves your thinking skills and expands your vocabulary. You will be able to identify and narrow down the topics and ideas you are drawn to.
- **Engage in solo exercise and individual sports:** It helps you to learn how to be self-reliant. Here, your success is entirely dependent on your own efforts, and you don't have anyone else to blame if you fail. This helps teach people responsibility and decision-making skills.
- **Practice conscious breathing:** Timing: Reactive. Conscious breathing improves overall function, relaxes the mind and spirit and helps you overcome anxiety and negative thoughts. Check out this quick guide on conscious breathing.

PHYSICAL EXERCISES

Meditate: The quest for self-awareness requires you to stop thinking and stop doing for a period of time in order listen to and understand your inner workings. Meditation is the perfect practice to help you calm your mind and become more focused

WITH HELP FROM OTHERS

- **Ask for constructive feedback at work/study:** Regularly asking for constructive feedback from people you trust at work, helps you identify the blind spots in your behavior and thinking at work. Take it as an opportunity to see where you have room to grow and improve.
- **Ask trusted friends or family for feedback:** Ask your friends and family to provide feedback, be it positive or negative, on different aspects of your life. This may help you learn something about yourself that you would never otherwise notice.
- **Apologize:** Once you are aware of your flaws and feel accountable for your actions, you can get closure on these issues. Make sincere apologies to people who deserve them from you, and learn from your mistakes.



Optimism



What Is Optimism?

- Optimism comes from the Latin word ***optimus*** meaning '***best***'
- Winston Churchill once said, "*A pessimist sees the difficulty in every opportunity; an optimist sees the opportunity in every difficulty.*"
- Optimism in behavioral psychology refers to **a mental attitude characterized by hope and confidence in positive outcomes, influencing how individuals interpret life events.**
- It describes how an optimistic person is always looking for the best in any situation and expecting good things to happen.

Types of Optimism

- **Dispositional optimism, or “big optimism”**, is the worldwide expectation that more good than bad will happen in the future.
- **Unrealistic optimism** is when positive expectations and the actual evidence don't match.
- **Comparative optimism** is expecting good things for yourself as compared to another person.
- **Situational optimism** is the expectation of a good outcome in a specific situation.
- **Strategic optimism** involves denying risks because you believe you have control.
- **Realistic optimism** involves keeping a positive outlook within the constraints of this world.

Explanatory Styles and Their Influence

- An important concept in understanding optimism is the idea of explanatory styles, which refers to how people attribute causes to events.
- Optimists are likely to see the causes of failure or negative experiences as **temporary rather than permanent, specific rather than global, and external rather than internal**.

Optimist Explanatory Style	Pessimist Explanatory Style
Optimists believe positive events as results of their own actions (internal).	Pessimists believe that negative events are caused by their own mistakes or traits (internal).
They also see them as evidence that more positive things will happen in the future (stable) and in other areas of their lives (global).	They believe that one mistake means more will come (stable), and mistakes in other areas of life are inevitable (global) because they are the cause.
They see negative events as not being their fault (external). They also see them as being flukes (isolated) that have nothing to do with other areas of their lives or future events (local).	They see positive events as flukes (local) that are caused by things outside their control (external) and probably won't happen again (unstable).

What Causes Someone to Be Optimistic or Not?

- Psychological characteristics
- Nature (genetics and biology)
- Nurture (your surroundings)
 - Childhood experiences
 - Financial situation
 - Educational level
 - Relationships with other people

Optimists	Pessimists
Attribute positive events to internal causes	Attribute positive events to external causes
Attribute negative events to external causes	Attribute negative events to internal causes
Believe that good things will happen in the future	Believe that bad things will happen in the future
Tend to view bad things as mistakes or random flukes	Tend to see good things as mistakes or flukes



What Optimism Feels Like and How It Potentially Affects Your Health

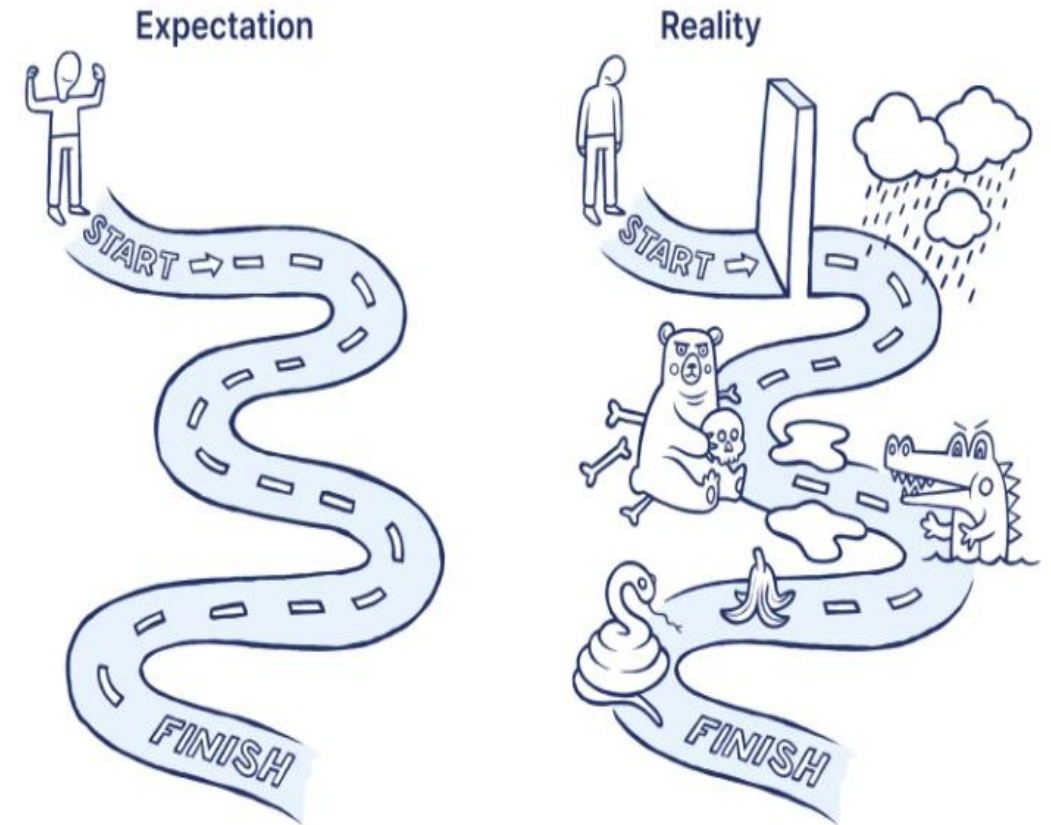
- Having a positive perspective has a positive impact on mental and emotional well-being, as optimists tend to experience **lower stress levels** and **higher resilience** in coping with challenges.
- Optimistic individuals often exhibit **lower levels of depression and anxiety, higher satisfaction in life.**
- There are therapeutic strategies – Cognitive Behavioural Therapy to help pessimists – to promote optimism in individuals.
- Optimism may lead you to make healthier choices.
- Optimism may change the body in positive ways.
- Optimism may help you have better relationships.
- Optimism may help you cope with stress.

Optimism and Health Outcomes

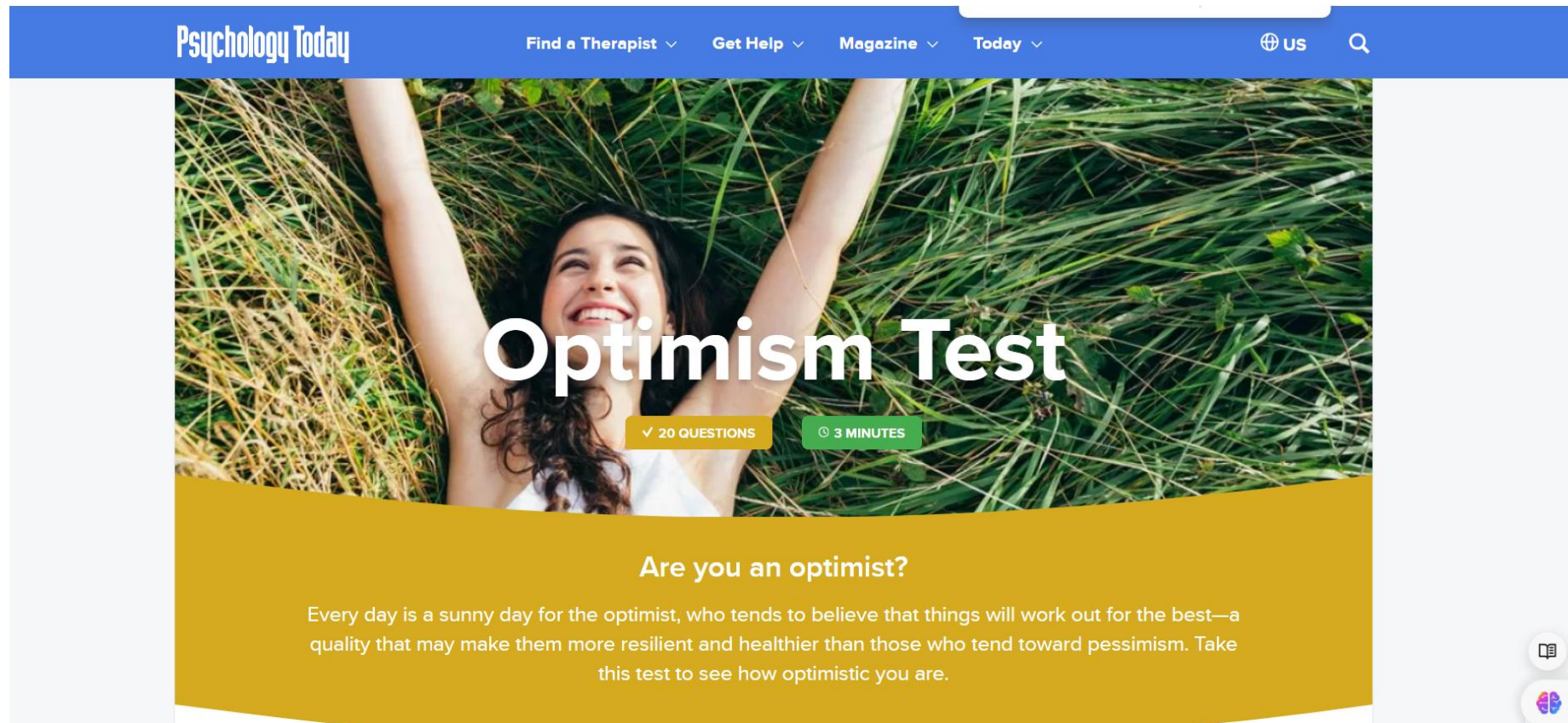
- Optimists have healthier outlooks. Optimism doesn't only affect mental health; it also has significant implications for physical health.
- Optimism helps buffer the negative effects of physical illness and is associated with better health outcomes in general.
- More likely to engage in healthy lifestyle choices and proactive health behaviors.
- Studies have linked higher levels of optimism to reduced rates of cardiovascular disease and improved survival rates among cancer patients. People who are more optimistic have better pain management, and greater physical functioning.

Can being overly optimistic ever be harmful?

- Optimism bias: The tendency to overestimate the likelihood of positive outcomes and downplay the possibility of negative ones
- In other words, a mistaken belief that one's chances of experiencing a negative event are lower (or a positive event higher).
- Ex. A chain-smoker strongly believing he will not get cancer.
- This bias was first demonstrated by Weinstein (1980)



<https://www.psychologytoday.com/us/tests/personality/optimism-test>



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US 🔍

Optimism Test

✓ 20 QUESTIONS ⌚ 3 MINUTES

Are you an optimist?

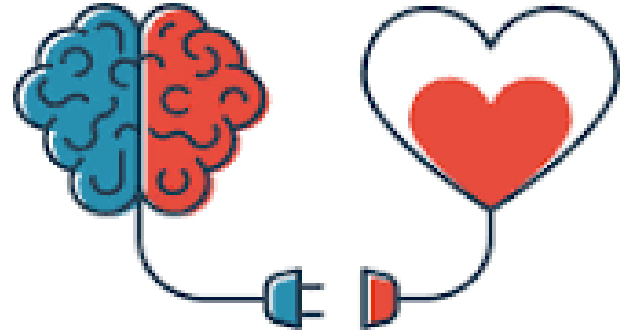
Every day is a sunny day for the optimist, who tends to believe that things will work out for the best—a quality that may make them more resilient and healthier than those who tend toward pessimism. Take this test to see how optimistic you are.

Understanding Emotions, Building Emotional Competence, Emotional Maturity, and Emotional Intelligence

Enhancing Self-Awareness
and Personal Growth



Introduction



Emotions play a crucial role in how we think, behave, and interact with others.

Understanding and managing emotions is key to personal and academic success.

Understanding Emotions

Emotions are complex psychological states that involve a subjective experience, a physiological response, and a behavioral or expressive response.

Examples of Common Emotions:

Happiness, sadness, anger, fear, surprise, disgust

Why Emotions Matter:

They guide decision-making, influence behavior, and affect relationships.

Dr. Robert Plutchik's Wheel of Emotions

Try it:

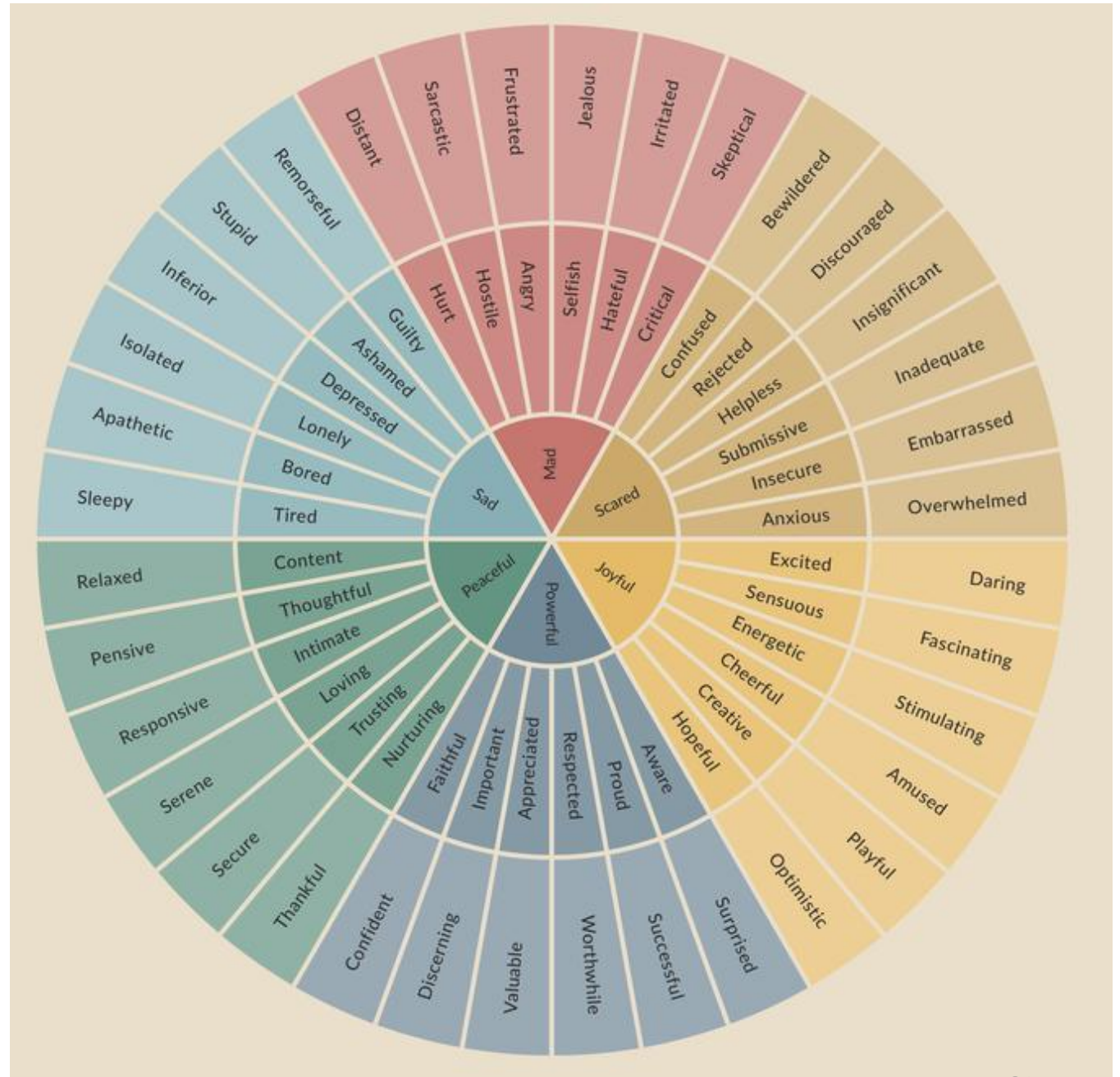
<https://www.6seconds.org/2025/02/06/plutchik-wheel-emotions/>

We process emotions on a subconscious level. It can be hard to first identify and verbalize our needs. This tool enables the user to visualize their emotions, and understand which combinations of emotions created this outcome.

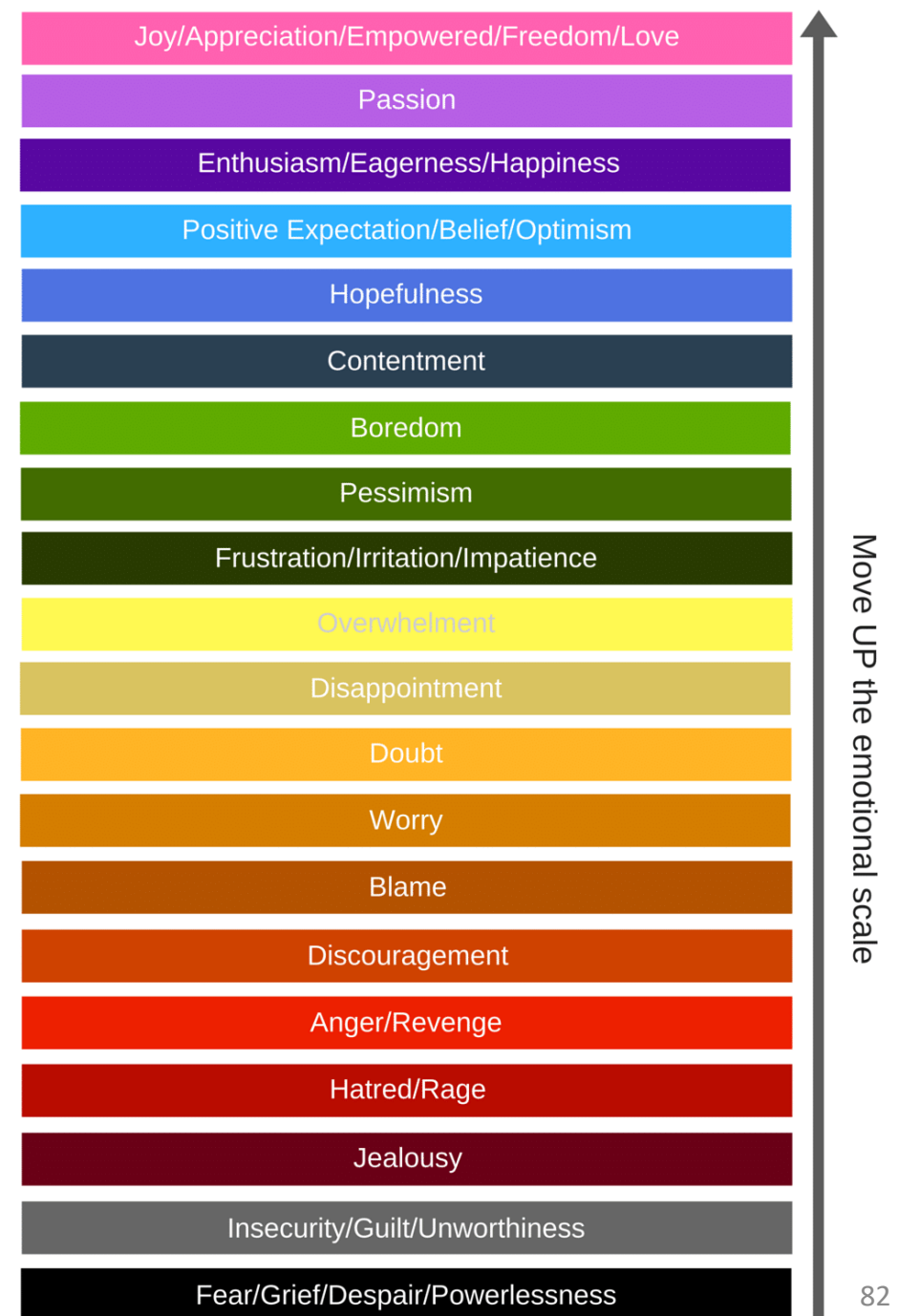


The Feeling Wheel

- primary emotions, secondary emotions, and tertiary emotions
- a guide to understand the intricate web of emotions we all feel and their interconnectedness with other emotions
- facilitates effective communication
- encourages mindful reflection
- support emotional regulation
- identify emotional patterns and triggers
- enhance emotional awareness
- improves emotional literacy



The (Vibrational) Emotional Scale



Building Emotional Competence

Emotional competence is the ability to effectively manage and respond to emotional experiences.

The Four Pillars Of Emotional Intelligence

01

Self-Awareness

- Recognize your own emotions.
- Understand how they influence your actions.

02

Self-Regulation

- Manage emotions in a healthy way.
- Adapt to changing circumstances.

03

Empathy

- Understand other people's emotions.
- Offer comfort and support.

04

Social Skills

- Build and maintain relationships.
- Effective communication.

Developing Emotional Maturity

Emotional maturity is the ability to handle situations and emotions with a sense of perspective and responsibility.

Characteristics of Emotional Maturity:

- Ability to delay gratification
- Adaptability and resilience
- Responsiveness instead of reactivity
- Accountability for emotions and actions

Tips for Developing Emotional Maturity:

- Reflect on experiences and learn from them
- Practice patience and mindfulness
- Build strong, supportive relationships



Understanding Emotional Intelligence (EQ)

Emotional Intelligence is the ability to perceive, use, understand, and manage emotions in yourself and others.

Components of EQ (Daniel Goleman's Model):



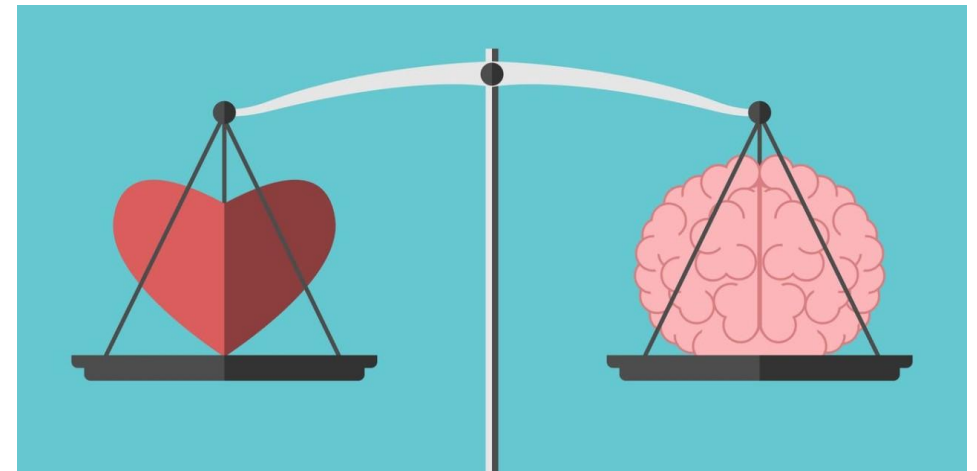
Benefits of High Emotional Intelligence

Personal Benefits:

- Improved mental health and well-being
- Better stress management and resilience
- Enhanced self-awareness and personal growth

Academic and Professional Benefits:

- Better teamwork and collaboration
- Improved leadership abilities
- Greater success in managing conflicts



Techniques to Improve Emotional Intelligence

Self-awareness:

Journaling, mindfulness practices, feedback from others



Self-regulation:

Stress management techniques, positive reframing

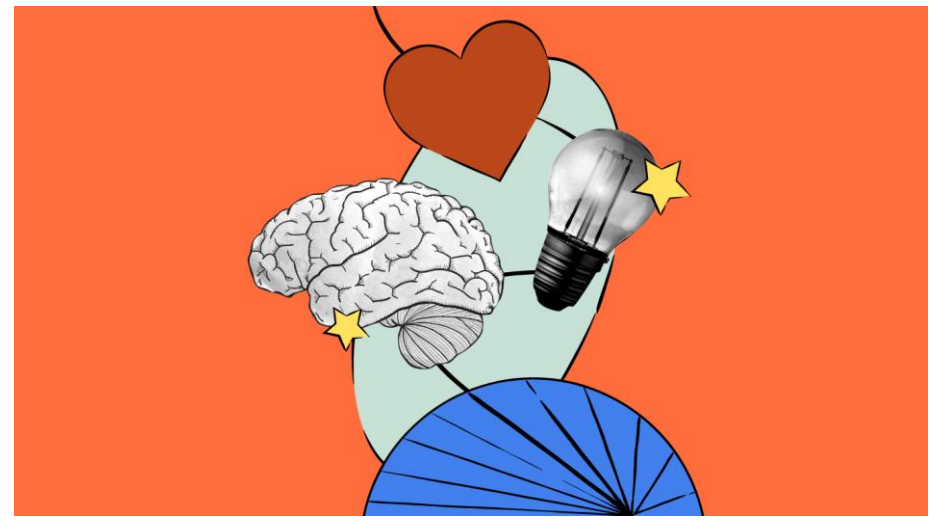
Empathy:

Active listening, engaging in perspective-taking exercises



Social Skills:

Practice effective communication, engage in team activities



- Understanding emotions and building emotional competence, maturity, and intelligence are essential life skills.
- These skills enhance personal well-being, academic performance, and relationships.

“Emotional intelligence is the key to both personal and professional success.”

Self-Esteem: Understanding and Building It

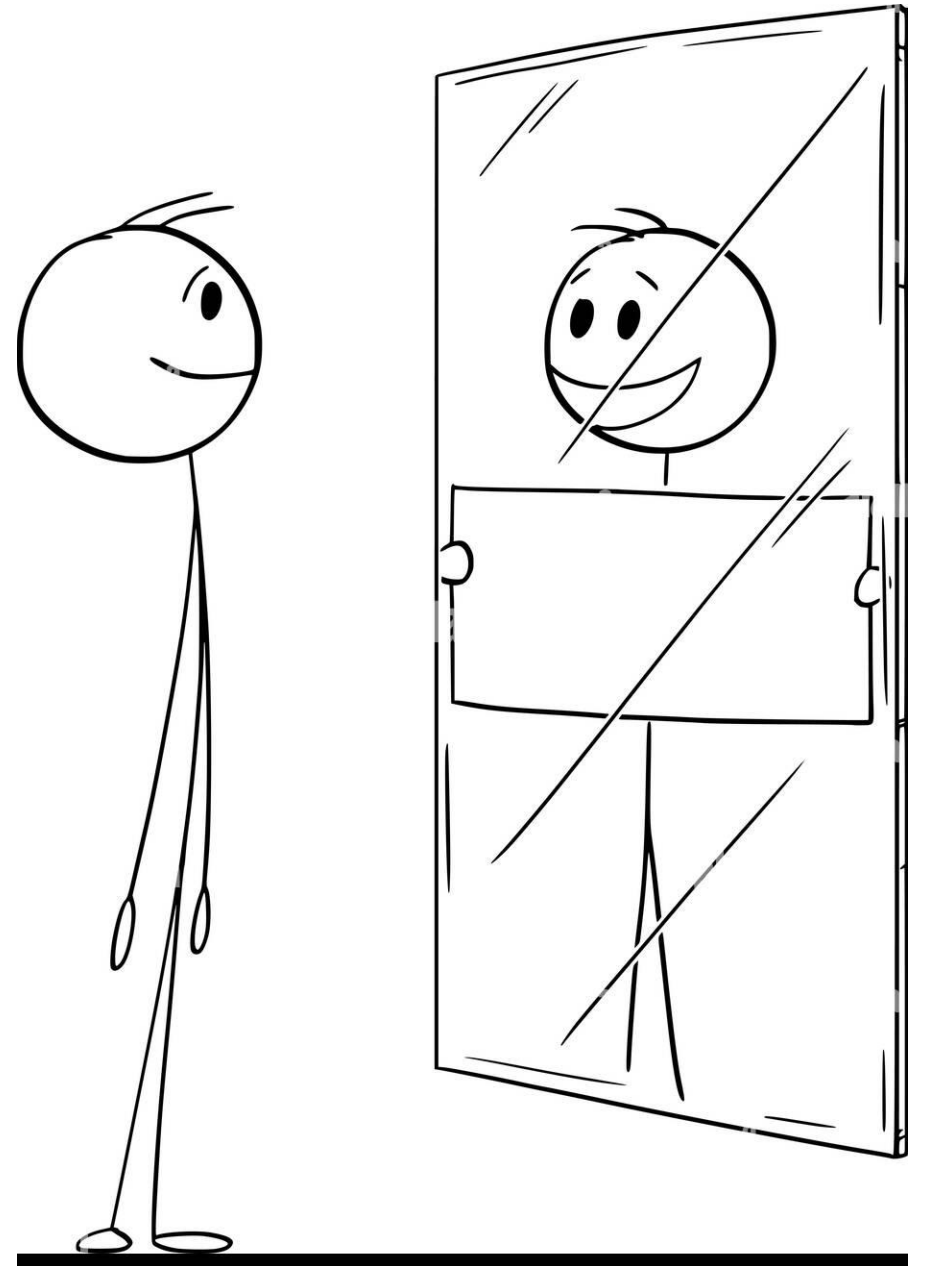
Boosting Confidence and Self-Worth



Self-esteem

Self-esteem is how you perceive your worth and value.

It influences how you think, feel, and behave.



Self-esteem

- Self-esteem is the overall sense of self-worth or personal value.
- It includes beliefs about oneself and emotional states like pride or shame.

Importance of Self-Esteem:

- Influences mental health, decision-making, and relationships.
- Affects motivation and resilience in facing challenges.



Components of Self-Esteem

- Self-Confidence:** Belief in your abilities and judgment.
- Self-Respect:** Valuing your own rights and feelings.
- Self-Worth:** Feeling that you are deserving of love and respect.
- Self-Acceptance:** Embracing yourself, including strengths and weaknesses.



Factors Influencing Self-Esteem

- **Personal Experiences:** Successes and failures, feedback from others.
- **Family Influence:** Support, criticism, and expectations from family.
- **Social Environment:** Peer relationships, societal standards, and media.
- **Physical and Mental Health:** Body image, stress levels, mental well-being.



Signs of Healthy Self-Esteem

- Confidence in making decisions and taking on new challenges.
- Ability to handle criticism without feeling overly hurt.
- Balanced view of strengths and weaknesses.
- Healthy relationships where boundaries are respected.



Signs of Low Self-Esteem

- Constant self-criticism and doubt.
- Sensitivity to criticism and rejection.
- Lack of confidence and reluctance to take risks.
- Seeking approval and validation from others.



Building Self-Esteem: Strategies



- **Positive Self-Talk:** Replace negative thoughts with positive affirmations.
- **Set Achievable Goals:** Break tasks into manageable steps to build confidence.
- **Embrace Self-Compassion:** Treat yourself with kindness and understanding.
- **Seek Support:** Surround yourself with supportive and positive people.
- **Practice Self-Care:** Engage in activities that nurture your physical and mental well-being.

Building Self-Esteem



- **Think Positively** – Believe in yourself and focus on your strengths.
- **Take Care of Yourself** – Eat well, exercise, and get enough rest.
- **Set Small Goals** – Achieve little things daily to boost confidence.
- **Avoid Negative People** – Be around those who uplift you.
- **Stop Comparing Yourself** – Focus on your own progress.
- **Speak Confidently** – Stand tall, make eye contact, and express yourself.
- **Try New Things** – Step out of your comfort zone to grow.
- **Be Kind to Yourself** – Forgive mistakes and learn from them.

Building Self-Esteem



- **Daily Affirmations** - Start each day by affirming your strengths.
- **Gratitude Journaling** - Write down things you're grateful for and achievements.
- **Challenge Negative Beliefs** - Identify and reframe negative thoughts about yourself.
- **Visualization** - Imagine yourself succeeding in different scenarios.
- **Volunteer** - Helping others can boost your sense of self-worth.

Overcoming Self-Esteem Challenges

- **Dealing with Failure:** View failures as learning opportunities.
- **Handling Criticism:** Learn to differentiate between constructive and destructive criticism.
- **Combating Perfectionism:** Understand that perfection is unattainable, and focus on progress.
- **Avoiding Comparisons:** Focus on your own journey and achievements.





Self-Esteem Tree



Self-esteem tree activity

 "Today, we will use the Self-Esteem Tree to reflect on our professional and personal self-concept as educators. Draw a tree with the following elements:"

ROOTS— Your Academic & Professional Foundations

- Draw one root for each **mentor, professor, or colleague** who has significantly shaped your academic and professional journey.
- This could include **teachers, advisors, role models, or early inspirations** who influenced your career path.
- Write their **names** in the roots or draw a symbol that represents their contribution.

TRUNK — Your Core Strengths as an Educator

- The trunk represents **your key strengths** that keep you grounded.
- Write **3-5 qualities** that define you as a faculty member.
- These could include **teaching skills, research expertise, leadership, mentoring abilities, or resilience.**

BRANCHES — Your Academic & Professional Network

- Each branch represents **people who support you in your current professional journey.**
- These could be **colleagues, students, research collaborators, department heads, or professional organizations.**
- Label each branch with a name or role.

FRUITS — Your Achievements & Contributions

- Fruits symbolize **your successes and contributions.**
- These could be **awards, publications, student mentorship success, leadership roles, or a project that had an impact.**
- Write a **word or draw a symbol** for each achievement.

FLOWERS — What Makes You Feel Confident in Your Role?

- Each flower represents something that **makes you feel good about yourself as an educator.**
- It could be **student feedback, achievements, a lesson that went well, or a publication you're proud of.**

LEAVES — Key Events That Shaped You as a Faculty Member

- Leaves represent **milestones or experiences that changed you.**
- Write significant events such as **getting your PhD, your first teaching experience, a major research breakthrough, or a challenging moment that helped you grow.**



- Self-esteem is vital for overall well-being and success.
- Building and maintaining self-esteem is an ongoing process.
- Start small, be patient, and remember that everyone's journey is different.

“Believe in yourself and all that you are. Know that there is something inside you that is greater than any obstacle.”

References:

- [Principles of Social Psychology - 1 st International H5P Edition](https://openstax.org/r/social-psychology-1st-edition)

[https://openstax.org/r/social-psychology/chapter/the-feeling-self-self-esteem/](https://openstax.org/r/social-psychology-1st-edition)

Overcoming Low Self Esteem

- Having low self esteem can cause hindrance to oneself. As one gets older, may face taking tough decisions, especially under pressure. The more self-esteem or self-worth one has the better decision-making abilities.
- Is it very important to understand and knows his or her worth.
- Activity Overcoming Low self esteem

How to identify Low self esteem

- Symptom's of low self-esteem are:
 - Fears like – no one loves me, my friends do not like me, I am useless etc..
 - Feeling of shame – I am not rich, I am dark, I am a curse on earth etc..
 - Depressed feelings – That is feeling and sad for a long time
 - Unrealistic expectations and feelings bad upon not achieving it.
 - Body image problem – not liking one's looks in general
 - Belief that the world is a “bad place” - finding everything unfair to them

Activity – 30 minutes

1. Do you love yourself? Describe the ways in which you take care of yourself?
2. List 5 things that you love to do?
3. Write 5 of your good qualities are:
4. Have you ever laughed at yourself? Describe the situation
5. Have you helped any person or animal in the recent past – describe the situation



Tips to Overcome



Love yourself: Take care of yourself. Remember that you are unique.



Do what you love: This would give you a good feeling.



Write down your good qualities: This would remind you of your strengths.



Develop long and short term goals: This can keep you motivated.



Have a sense of humour: Learn to laugh at yourself.



Help others – both people and animals: This brings pure joy and satisfaction.



Drop your negative friends: Because they pull down your confidence



Celebrate success: Celebration boosts self-confidence and good feeling.

Competency

“ *Our competence to excel in life depends on our ability to do what we can do.*

– Chief Executive Officer of The WhistleMag, Sijin BT²

- A competency is defined as a **capability or ability** (Boyatzis 2008).
- Competence can be defined as the **knowledge, skills, attitudes, values, and judgment** needed to **perform the work of a particular profession**. Competence, or at least the perception of competence, is crucial for experts in any field, as without it, others will not **trust** them to perform their job effectively.
- It is a set of **related but different sets of behavior organized around an underlying construct** called the “**intent**”. The behaviors are alternate manifestations of the intent, as appropriate in various situations or times.
- Example: You are asking questions in a discussion. Intent is to appear interested / show empathy/ understand the person.
- The underlying intent of a more subtle competency like **emotional self-awareness** is **self-insight** and **self-understanding**.

History



Robert White, a Clinical Psychologist – **first explored competence** academically “***Motivation reconsidered: The concept of competence***” (1959). He suggested competence was not just the outcome of a task, but the **driving factor** in engaging in that behavior. He believed people **engaged in behaviors** in which **they were competent** because it made them **feel good about themselves**.

Clark Hull, a Behaviorist and Psychologist (1950s) who attempted to give **mathematical expression** to psychological phenomena. He believed all behavior could be explained by **conditioning principles**. Hull developed the ***Drive Reduction Theory***, which suggested biological deprivation created motivation.



History

- **Susan Harter**, a psychologist who developed **models of competence for various age groups** *“Effectance motivation reconsidered: Toward a developmental model”* (1978) . She began from White’s theory, that people were motivated to partake in tasks they were successful in because of positive reinforcement. She created **scales to rate levels of competence** so people could measure it, as White had only theoretically discussed competence. For children, she eventually developed her model to include **five domains of competence: scholastic, athletic, social, physical appearance, and behavioral conduct**. Later, she developed a similar **scale for adolescents** that included **three additional domains: close friendship, romantic appeal, and job competence**.
- **Stuart Dreyfus** and **Hubert Dreyfus**, an engineering professor and philosophy professor, respectively, who devised a **model for skill acquisition** in 1980, for people to self-assess their level of expertise. They identified **five stages: novice, advanced beginner, competent, proficient, and expert**. The model assumes that skill acquisition is a **matter of experience rather than inherent skill**, and that over time, **people progress from novice all the way to expert**. According to their understanding of competence, they hypothesized that it **takes a student two to three years before they are competent**. When competent, they know many rules and procedures necessary for their role, but don’t always know how to apply them.

Threshold clusters of competencies

Outstanding people appear to require **three clusters of behavioral habits** as threshold abilities and **three clusters of competencies** as distinguishing outstanding performance.

1. **expertise and experience;**
2. **knowledge** (i.e. declarative, procedural, functional and meta-cognitive); and
3. an assortment of **basic cognitive competencies**, such as memory and deductive reasoning.

There are three clusters of competencies that differentiate outstanding from average performers in many countries of the world

1. ***Cognitive competencies***, such as **systems thinking** and **pattern recognition**.
2. ***Emotional intelligence competencies***, including **self-awareness** and **self-management competencies**, such as **emotional self-awareness** and **emotional self-control**.
3. ***Social intelligence competencies***, including **social awareness** and **relationship management competencies**, such as **empathy** and **teamwork**.

Consequences in the context of Competence

- **Competence** might be a **better way to predict success than other markers, such as intelligence**. While someone might have a very high IQ, that doesn't necessarily tell us if they will be successful in a particular task or role. Since competence is **measured as a result of behavior**, it can be argued that it is a **better measure of performance**.
- Understanding competence can help organizations and institutions ensure their **staff and students are motivated to perform their role** through various strategies. If competence is a motivating factor, then supervisors can give praise when it is deserved. The **positive affirmation** will make an **individual feel good**, which in turn will **make them more likely to repeat that behavior**.

Controversy in the context of competence

- Is competence something one can really measure? - Is it being an expert or perfectly completing a task? OR Is it completing a task adequately?
- *COVID-19 & Medical Competence* - definitions of competence is “*the capacity to respond to individual or societal demands in order to perform an activity or complete a given task.*”

Reference books:

- Self-management and Behavior Change: From Theory to Practice. (1982). United States: Pergamon Press.



Building Responsibility



Responsibility

- Responsibility refers to the state or fact of having a duty to deal with something or of being accountable for something or someone. It implies an obligation to perform tasks, fulfill roles, or meet expectations, often tied to moral, legal, or social standards.
- According to Paul Ricoeur in "Oneself as Another" (1992), responsibility is closely tied to moral agency, suggesting that individuals are accountable for their actions when they can recognize the consequences of those actions on others and the self.
- Similarly, in Stephen Covey's "The 7 Habits of Highly Effective People", responsibility is discussed as the ability to choose your response—emphasizing personal accountability and proactive behavior.

Key Components:

- Accountability – Answering for actions or decisions.
- Obligation – A duty imposed by moral or legal norms.
- Proactivity – Taking initiative rather than waiting for direction.
- Consequences – Understanding and accepting outcomes of decisions.

Activity 1: Responsibility Sorting Card

Objective:

Builds critical thinking about what responsibility looks like in action.

Instruction: Ask them to identify responsible and irresponsible behavior?

Faculty Notes:

- Discuss gray areas: *Can a responsible person make mistakes? What makes the difference?*

Learning Outcomes: Learn to understand and differentiate between responsible and irresponsible behaviour

Activity 2:

Responsibility Role Play

Objective: Helps practice communication, ownership, and accountability.

Instruction: How to Play: Group or Individual activity

1. The Last-Minute Assignment: Scenario:

It's 8 PM. You're lying on your bed, phone in hand, scrolling through videos. Suddenly, a message pops up in the class group: "Don't forget the assignment is due tomorrow morning!" You stare at the screen. You haven't even started.

-  Responsible Reaction:
 - You sit up, sigh, and say to yourself, *"Okay, I can do this. If I start now, I can finish by 10."* You put your phone away, gather your notes, and begin working. Later, you feel tired—but proud.
-  Irresponsible Reaction:
 - You shrug and think, *"It's too late now, anyway. Maybe I can make an excuse."* You keep scrolling. The next morning, you feel anxious and annoyed when the teacher asks for your work.

Activity 3: The own it Journal

Purpose: Encourages self-reflection and personal growth.

Instructions:

- Ask students to list 2 recent situations where they were responsible, and 1 where they could've done better.
- For each, reflect on:
 - What did I do?
 - What was the result?
 - What could I do differently next time?

ACTIVITY 4: Responsibility Pledge Wall

Instructions:

- Ask students to write one thing they will take more responsibility for this month on a sticky note or digital board.
- Create a “Responsibility Wall” or digital collage.
-  *Purpose:* Makes commitments visible and encourages peer accountability.